
What was checked and what was not

LEGALITY AND DIAGRAMS

Every opening anchor was parsed as legal SAN. Every printed continuation was replayed from the starting position, and every diagram was generated from the resulting board. Second-move choices, custom structure positions and exercise answers were also checked against legal moves.

ENGINE SCREENING

Stockfish 18 used two threads and a 128 MB hash. White anchor decisions after move two were screened with 60,000-node searches; differences above 0.85 pawns were rechecked at 450,000 nodes. Flagged draft choices were reviewed and corrected. Every final ordinary repertoire anchor has no unresolved flag under this test. The deliberately losing Lasker-trap line is excluded from White-recommendation screening.

SAMPLE CONTINUATIONS

Short anchors were extended toward ten full moves with 120,000-node searches, then their final positions checked at 300,000 nodes. Eight laboratory lines were extended toward twenty full moves using 300,000-node searches. These are finite checks, not exhaustive opening analysis or proof that a line is objectively best.

HUMAN PURPOSE

The course favors coherent, understandable positions and practical answers. An engine can prefer a different sound move. A good outcome is arriving at a position you understand, with no avoidable tactical concession - not claiming a forced win against every defense.

COVERAGE AND OMISSIONS

The main route covers common queen-pawn defenses and important gambits. The Nimzo is optional. Other good White systems, deep novelties and every rare Black move are not all separate repertoires here. Booklet 01 supplies a decision framework for unfamiliar moves.

HOW TO UPDATE THE COURSE

After a game, check the exact position in an opening database and analyze the opponent's concrete idea. Add a short branch with a reason. Do not replace an entire sound repertoire merely because one finite engine evaluation changes.

Sources and further study

OPENING NAMES AND MOVE-ORDER REFERENCE

Lichess chess-openings, public-domain/CC0 dataset. Local snapshots of a.tsv through e.tsv were downloaded for this project. Facts and names are reference material; the course is an original selection, not a reproduction of a published repertoire.

<https://github.com/lichess-org/chess-openings>

ENGINE VERIFICATION

Official Stockfish 18, Windows AVX2 build. Used locally to screen selected White decisions and generate explicitly labelled sample continuations.

<https://stockfishchess.org/download/>

ALBIN CROSS-CHECK

Ian Simpson's analysis of a3 and Nbd2 lines was consulted for the strategic distinction and the ...Nge7/e4 queen-trade idea. Commentary in this course is newly written.

<https://www.ianchessgambits.com/albin-counter-gambit-a3-and-nbd2.html>

Sources and further study

QUEEN'S INDIAN REFERENCE

Chess.com's opening overview was used to cross-check the distinction between ...Ba6 and ...Bb7.

<https://www.chess.com/openings/Queens-Indian-Defense>

ISOLATED PAWN TERMINOLOGY

Chess.com's isolated-pawn reference was consulted for terminology; the diagrams and exercises here use this course's own positions.

<https://www.chess.com/terms/isolated-pawn-chess>

PAWN MAJORITY AND MINORITY ATTACK TERMINOLOGY

Chess.com's pawn-majority reference was consulted for the definition of a minority attack.

<https://www.chess.com/terms/pawn-majority-chess>

Sources and further study

DIAGRAM IMPLEMENTATION AND ARTWORK

python-chess SVG documentation identifies the Colin M. L. Burnett / Cburnett pieces and their licensing. The supplied example.pdf was the visual reference for cream-and-green squares and clear dark-outlined pieces.

<https://python-chess.readthedocs.io/en/latest/svg.html>

Working chess vocabulary

SAN

Standard Algebraic Notation: Nf3, cxd5, Qxd8+, O-O. N is a knight; K is a king. The + sign means check and # means checkmate.

PLY

One move by one side. Ten full moves normally contain twenty plies: White's move and Black's reply each count once.

TABIYA

A useful starting position for studying an opening's middlegame plans after the initial developing moves.

TRANSPOSITION

Reaching the same position through a different move order. Side to move, castling rights and en-passant availability must also agree.

TEMPO

A unit of time measured by a move. Attacking a piece with a useful developing move can gain a tempo.

INITIATIVE

The ability to make threats that force the opponent to respond. It can compensate for a pawn, but may disappear if development stalls.

FIANCHETTO

Developing a bishop to g2, b2, g7 or b7 behind a moved knight pawn, to influence a long diagonal.

Working chess vocabulary

PAWN BREAK

A pawn advance or capture that challenges a pawn chain, opens a file, or changes the central structure.

MINORITY ATTACK

Using fewer pawns on a wing to provoke a lasting weakness in the opponent's larger pawn group.

ISOLATED PAWN

A pawn with no friendly pawn on either adjacent file. Its activity and vulnerability depend on the position.

HANGING PAWNS

Usually an adjacent c- and d-pawn pair without friendly pawns on the neighboring outer files. They can give space or become targets.

BACKWARD PAWN

A pawn that cannot safely advance and lacks adequate support from neighboring pawns; it may become a target on a half-open file.

OUTPOST

A square a piece can occupy securely, often because an enemy pawn cannot readily drive it away.

BLOCKADE

Placing a piece in front of an enemy pawn to restrain its advance. A blockade must be supported.

Working chess vocabulary

PROPHYLAXIS

Recognizing and restricting the opponent's useful plan while improving your own position.

RELATIVE PIN

A piece may legally move but doing so exposes a more valuable piece. A pin to the king instead makes exposing the king illegal.

EN PASSANT

Immediately after a pawn advances two squares, an adjacent enemy pawn may capture it as though it advanced only one. This right lasts for one reply.

UNDERPROMOTION

Promoting a pawn to rook, bishop or knight instead of queen. A knight promotion can give a check the queen would not give.

COMPENSATION

Positional or dynamic benefits offered in return for material: activity, king attack, space, or lasting structural targets.

ENGINE CENTIPAWN SCORE

A numerical search evaluation, conventionally measured in hundredths of a pawn. It is not a win probability or proof of the position's result.

File guide and credits

INDIVIDUAL PDFS

Booklets 00-26 can be studied or printed independently. The combined volume includes the same pages and PDF outline bookmarks for each booklet. START HERE explains the reading order; Booklet 25 provides the weekly plan.

PGN COMPANIONS

Repertoire_Lines.pgn contains the selected study branches. Warning lines are explicitly labelled. Middlegame_Laboratory.pgn contains the eight illustrative continuations. Exercises.pgn stores the exercise positions and answers for replay. These are analysis files, not records of played games.

REPRODUCIBILITY

Course_Manifest.json records page counts and file hashes. Verification_Summary.txt records the check counts and limitations. The folder also includes the Cburnett piece sources and license material used for the diagrams.

ARTWORK

Chess pieces: Colin M. L. Burnett / Cburnett, as supplied in python-chess SVG rendering. Credit and source links are retained in the course and in the accompanying artwork folder. The board colors and page design were matched to your provided example.pdf.

ORIGINAL CONTENT

Instructional prose, exercises and course structure were written for this project. Public opening facts and local engine analysis support the selected lines. No commercial course or annotated book was copied.